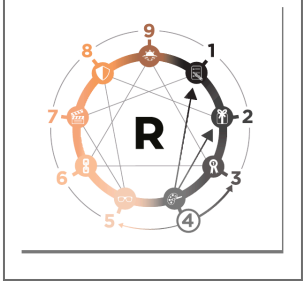
TYPE

4

THE INDIVIDUALIST

The Romantic



The Artistic Soul Who Creates Living Masterpieces

CORE MOTIVATION IN THE SALON

> Type Fours are driven by a desire to be unique, to express their authentic self, and to find deep meaning in their work. In the salon, they are often the most creative and distinctive stylists — their work is art, and they approach each client as a canvas for genuine expression.

CLIENT COMMUNICATION STYLE

- Fours communicate with depth, emotional attunement, and an instinct for what a client is really feeling — even when unsaid.
- They may be drawn to clients who appreciate their artistry, and feel misunderstood by clients who 'just want a trim.'
- **Natural strength:** Clients who want transformation — not just maintenance — feel deeply understood by a Four.
- **Growth edge:** Meeting clients where they are emotionally and practically, even when the request feels creatively uninspiring.

THE CONSULTATION

- Fours often give their most inspired consultations when they connect emotionally with what a client is trying to express through their hair.
- They can struggle with practical, low-maintenance requests — these may feel beneath their creative capacity.
- **Tip:** Teach Fours to find the creative opportunity in every consultation — even a classic bob has aesthetic depth worth exploring.

CREATIVITY & ARTISTRY

- Fours are the artists of the Enneagram. They are drawn to innovative color, sculptural cuts, and creative expression that feels personally meaningful.
- They may resist doing trends that 'everyone is doing' — they want to do something distinctly theirs.
- They can get lost in the process and lose track of time, practicality, or what the client actually asked for.
- Their best work happens when creative freedom aligns with client vision — when they feel trusted to create.

SELF-WORTH MASTERY: MOVING FROM FIXED TO GROWTH

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'Other stylists have something I don't — a clearer path, more confidence, an easier time with the business side.' → Name three things about your creative

vision that no one else in your market offers. That is not a gap in you — that is a gift for the clients who are looking for exactly what you do.

- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'The business side of this feels like a compromise of who I am as an artist.' → What if a thriving business gave you more creative freedom, not less? What is one business action — raising a price, posting your work, booking out a service — that would directly protect your ability to create?
- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'I only show up brilliantly when I'm inspired.' → Inspiration follows action more reliably than it precedes it. Choose one day this week where you do the work before you feel ready, and notice what happens to the quality. Write down what you created.
- **Fixed pattern → Growth prompt:** 'Real art speaks for itself — I shouldn't have to promote it.' → Your art cannot speak to someone who has never seen it. Who is your ideal client? Where are they right now, not knowing you exist? Post one piece of work this week with a caption that shows them who you are.
- **Your growth affirmation:** I am not missing anything. My depth, sensitivity, and distinctive vision are not flaws to manage — they are the exact qualities that make my work irreplaceable. I claim them fully.

BUILDING YOUR BUSINESS BEHIND THE CHAIR

- Fours build businesses best around their creative identity. Don't try to be all things to all clients — lean deeply into your signature aesthetic and let it attract the clients who are looking for exactly what you offer.
- Develop a visual brand that reflects your genuine aesthetic. Your portfolio IS your marketing — invest in photography that shows your work at its best. Fours who present their art beautifully attract clients who value art.
- Create a suite of signature services that are distinctly yours. Name them, story them, and price them accordingly. Artisanal positioning commands premium rates.
- Build consistency systems to bridge the gap between inspired days and unmotivated ones. Have a consultation template, a follow-up sequence, and a rebooking process that runs whether or not you feel creatively alive that day.
- Social media is a natural platform for a Four — share your creative process, your inspiration, your story. Authentic creative expression on social builds the exact kind of following that values a Four's work.
- Partner with photographers, makeup artists, and creative collaborators for editorial work that builds your portfolio and visibility in the creative community.

SELLING SERVICES & RETAIL

- Fours may resist retail selling that feels commercial or inauthentic — they don't want to be a 'salesperson.'
- They sell best when they can speak from genuine personal experience: 'I use this myself and it changed everything for me.'
- Reframe retail as curation — 'I curate the best tools for my clients the same way I curate my creative work.'
- Fours respond well when their product knowledge is treated as part of their artistry, not a numbers game.
- Fours are excellent at recommending products with distinctive quality or story — niche, artisanal, or deeply effective lines.
- They can make clients feel they are receiving something special and personally selected.
- **Watch for:** Inconsistent retail follow-through. Fours may only recommend products when inspired, missing many opportunities.

FEEDBACK, BOUNDARIES & TOUGH CONVERSATIONS WITH CLIENTS

- Fours experience feedback as deeply personal — because their work IS personal. A critique of the service can feel like a rejection of who they are.
- Developing the ability to separate the work from the self is one of the most powerful professional skills a Four can build. Practice: 'This feedback is about this service on this day — it is data, not a verdict.'
- **With unhappy clients:** Fours can swing between over-apologizing (feeling deep shame) or withdrawing (feeling misunderstood). Neither serves the client. Aim for grounded accountability: acknowledge, understand, offer a solution.
- **Setting boundaries:** Fours often tolerate clients who don't appreciate their work because they desperately want to be understood. But a client who consistently devalues your creativity is not your client — releasing them is self-respect.
- **Giving feedback:** Fours are often exquisitely honest and can give deeply insightful feedback. The challenge is timing and delivery — lead with what's working before exploring what could shift.
- Tough conversations require Fours to stay present rather than retreating into their inner world. Practice: say what you see, say what you feel, say what you need. Three sentences, out loud, before you disappear.

TEAM DYNAMICS, FEEDBACK & UTILIZING YOUR GIFTS ON A SALON TEAM

- On a salon team, Fours bring creative inspiration, emotional depth, and a willingness to do things differently. They are the ones who push the team toward more interesting work.
- They are often the most original thinker on the team — and their aesthetic sensibility can elevate the entire salon's brand.
- **Natural team contribution:** Creative inspiration, editorial vision, emotional intelligence in client relationships, and the artistic courage to try something new.
- **Growth edge:** Showing up consistently — even when uninspired. Teams depend on reliability, and a Four who disappears emotionally creates a burden for their colleagues.
- **Watch for:** Feeling perpetually misunderstood by the team. If the Four consistently feels like no one 'gets' them, the problem may be as much in the communication as in the team.
- **Power move:** Lead a team creative day — an educational session built around artistic exploration. Fours in their element become extraordinary teachers who unlock creativity in others.
- Fours thrive in cultures that celebrate individuality and creative expression. In highly standardized or corporate salon environments, they may feel stifled — and their best work may never emerge.

CAREER PATH ALIGNMENT

- Session Stylist / Editorial Artist — freedom, creative expression, and working with vision-oriented clients
- Color Artist / Balayage Specialist — artistry, precision, and personal creative signature
- Salon Owner with a distinctive brand identity — the salon reflects their aesthetic entirely
- Educator with a unique creative POV — teaching what makes them distinctively them

STRESS & GROWTH PATHS

UNDER STRESS

Under stress (moving toward Type 2), Fours can become overly focused on others' feelings, lose their creative identity, and start performing connection rather than feeling it.

IN GROWTH

In growth (moving toward Type 1), Fours develop discipline and structure. They stop waiting for inspiration and build it into their process — and their output becomes both beautiful and reliable.

WINGS

Every type is influenced by one of its neighboring types — called a wing. While your core type remains primary, your wing adds flavor and nuance to how you show up in the salon.

4w3 — The Aristocrat

The 3 wing adds ambition and image-awareness to the Four's artistry. These stylists want to be both creatively authentic AND recognized for their work. They often build strong personal brands.

- **Client Style:** Artistic, polished, aspirational. Clients feel they are working with a true creative with something to say.
- **Selling Style:** Can speak beautifully about the story and craft behind products. Elevated, aesthetic language.
- **Challenge:** Tension between wanting authentic recognition and fear of being seen as 'selling out.'

4w5 — The Bohemian

The 5 wing adds depth, privacy, and intellectual curiosity. These stylists are deeply knowledgeable, somewhat introverted, and create with intense intentionality. Their work can be quietly extraordinary.

- **Client Style:** Thoughtful, understated, deeply attentive. Clients feel they are working with someone who truly sees them.
- **Selling Style:** Quiet, factual, and deeply knowledgeable. Won't recommend something unless they genuinely believe in it.
- **Challenge:** Can withdraw from the relational aspects of the business. Networking and promotion feel unnatural and draining.

YOUR GENIUS: A COSMETOLOGIST SUMMARY

GENIUS INSIGHT

Type Fours bring the rarest gift to the cosmetology profession: the willingness to treat the human being in the chair as a full person worthy of genuine creative attention. In a profession where transformation is the product, the Four's ability to truly see a client — their longing, their vision, the story they want their hair to tell — is not a soft skill. It is the core skill. The Four who learns to show up with consistency, to promote their gifts without apology, and to channel their depth into reliable excellence becomes not just a great stylist — they become a transformative force whose work changes how people see themselves. That is not a small thing. In the hands of a healthy Four, a haircut is an act of profound recognition.